

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Security Consultant | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft 365 Defender | Azure AD |
Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of deep, hands-on experience with the Microsoft security stack, specialising in Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft 365 Defender, and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID. I have designed and deployed security architectures and detection engineering solutions across complex hybrid and cloud environments, and I am proficient in Kusto Query Language (KQL) for building advanced correlation rules, threat hunting queries, and automated response playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across an 8,000-user estate, configured Conditional Access and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) policies in Entra ID, and engineered the detection content that underpins the organisation's security monitoring capability. I understand how to translate threat intelligence and adversary behaviour, as documented in the MITRE ATT&CK framework, into practical, high-fidelity detections. I bring a consultative mindset developed through working with diverse stakeholder groups, strong written communication skills for producing technical documentation and client-facing reports, and a hybrid working style suited to delivering across multiple client environments. I am eager to bring this Microsoft security expertise to Threatscape and help clients maximise the value of their Microsoft security investments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Log source integration and data connector configuration, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rule development, Analytics Rules, Workbooks, Playbooks (Logic Apps), Threat Intelligence integration, Sentinel Automation
- **Microsoft 365 Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployment and management (8,000+ users), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps; Advanced Hunting using KQL
- **Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID:** Conditional Access policy design, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Identity Protection, Entra ID Governance, Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, custom detection rule development, alert tuning and noise reduction, threat hunting, indicators of compromise (IOC) management
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel Playbooks (Azure Logic Apps), automated incident workflow design, SOAR integration with ticketing systems
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), EDR, Prevent), Tanium, Intune MDM / MAM, attack surface reduction (ASR)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, Azure AD RBAC, Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, Logic Apps
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST 800-61, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Serve as the primary engineer for Microsoft Sentinel, owning data connector configuration, log source integration, KQL detection rule development, and Playbook automation across a hybrid on-premises and Azure environment.

- Designed and deployed over 80 custom Microsoft Sentinel Analytics Rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, covering threat categories including credential theft, lateral movement, persistence, and data exfiltration.
- Conduct Advanced Hunting across Microsoft 365 Defender using KQL to perform proactive threat hunting and identify adversary activity not surfaced by automated detection rules.
- Led the end-to-end deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000+ users and devices, configuring attack surface reduction (ASR) rules, behavioural sensors, and automated investigation and remediation (AIR) workflows.
- Deployed and manage Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to monitor Active Directory for lateral movement, pass-the-hash, Kerberoasting, and other identity-based attack techniques.
- Design and maintain Azure AD / Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA configurations, and Identity Protection risk policies to protect cloud and hybrid identity infrastructure.
- Build and maintain Microsoft Sentinel Playbooks using Azure Logic Apps to automate common incident response actions, reducing mean time to respond by 30% and eliminating repetitive manual analyst tasks.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Entra ID Privileged Identity Management (PIM) to enforce just-in-time privileged access across administrative accounts.
- Produce technical documentation, detection runbooks, and security posture reports for senior stakeholders, translating complex technical findings into clear risk-based recommendations.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Monitored Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft 365 Defender dashboards, triaging and investigating alerts and escalating incidents in line with defined response playbooks and severity thresholds.
- Contributed to Sentinel detection rule tuning and KQL query development, improving detection accuracy and reducing false positive rates across the security monitoring platform.
- Supported Azure AD identity governance activities including access reviews, RBAC assignments, group management, and stale account remediation, aligning with least-privilege and zero-trust principles.
- Managed Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, ensuring compliant and secure access from managed and bring-your-own-device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and coordinated remediation workflows with infrastructure teams to achieve measurable improvements in the organisation's vulnerability posture.
- Maintained Check Point Harmony Firewall and Mimecast email security platforms, reviewing configurations and updating policies in response to evolving threats.
- Produced technical runbooks, incident reports, and security documentation to support the team's knowledge base and client-facing reporting capability.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Maintained and hardened security controls across SaaS cloud and on-premises infrastructure, applying security baselines and CIS Controls benchmarks to endpoints and servers.
- Managed user identity and access provisioning, enforcing role-based access controls and least-privilege principles to protect sensitive FinTech platform data.
- Monitored infrastructure security events, investigated incidents, and implemented engineering corrections to strengthen the security posture of a regulated technology environment.
- Contributed to infrastructure compliance and security quality assurance activities, producing evidence for internal audits and external assessments.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed 80+ custom Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, achieving a 35% reduction in mean time to detect across the UAL environment.
- Reduced Sentinel false positive alert volume by over 40% through systematic detection tuning, enabling analysts to focus capacity on genuine threats.
- Led Microsoft Defender for Endpoint deployment across 8,000+ users, achieving full endpoint visibility and materially reducing undetected endpoint compromise events.

- Delivered Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA rollout, eliminating a category of credential-based attacks affecting remote workers.
- Built Microsoft Sentinel Playbooks that automated 30% of common incident response actions, reducing analyst toil and accelerating mean time to respond.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000 + Benefits | Hybrid (London/Manchester)